

Chapter 3: The Way He Looked at Her

Luna couldn't move.

Her eyes stayed fixed on him—

the boy she had only seen on a banner...

now standing right in front of her.

Real.

Alive.

Breathing.

"This... isn't possible," she whispered, her voice barely audible.

The boy tilted his head slightly, a soft smile forming on his lips.

"If it feels real... does it have to be impossible?"

His voice.

It was warm.

Gentle.

Like it wrapped around her heart without asking permission.

Luna swallowed, her fingers curling slightly.

"I've seen you before," she said slowly.

"I know," he replied.

Her brows furrowed. "How do you know that?"

He stepped closer.

Not too close.

Just enough for her to feel his presence.

“Because,” he said softly, “you were looking at me like I was the only thing in your world.”

Her heart skipped.

She quickly looked away.

“That’s not true.”

He smiled.

“It is.”

There was something about the way he spoke.

Not teasing.

Not mocking.

Just... certain.

Like he understood her in a way no one ever had.

“I’m Kyros,” he said, extending his hand toward her.

Luna stared at it for a moment.

Her mind told her to stop.

To question.

To run.

But her heart... moved first.

She slowly placed her hand in his.

“...Luna.”

His fingers closed around hers.

Warm.

Steady.

Safe.

And for a moment...

Everything inside her went quiet.

Kyros didn't let go immediately.

Instead, he gently pulled her forward.

"Come with me."

She didn't resist.

Didn't even think.

She just followed.

They walked through the field together.

The grass brushed softly against her feet.

The air felt lighter with every step.

No noise.

No pressure.

No heaviness in her chest.

Just peace.

She looked around, amazed.

"It's so... calm," she whispered.

Kyros glanced at her.

"That's how it's supposed to feel."

Her eyes met his.

“In my world... it’s never like this.”

He slowed down.

“Tell me about your world.”

Luna hesitated.

“There’s nothing to tell,” she said quietly.

“It’s just... tiring.”

Kyros’s expression softened.

“Then don’t think about it right now.”

He gently brushed a strand of hair away from her face.

Her breath caught.

“Here,” he said, his voice almost a whisper,

“you don’t have to carry anything.”

Her heart started racing.

Not from fear.

But from something she hadn’t felt in a long time.

Care.

They reached a large tree and sat down beneath it.

The sunlight filtered through the leaves, casting soft shadows around them.

For a while, neither of them spoke.

But the silence wasn’t uncomfortable.

It was... peaceful.

“Why me?” Luna suddenly asked.

Kyros turned to her.

“What do you mean?”

“Why are you here... with me?” she asked.

“There are so many people in the world.”

He didn’t answer immediately.

Instead, he leaned slightly closer.

Close enough for her to feel his breath.

“Because you needed someone,” he said softly.

“And I wanted to be that someone.”

Her eyes widened slightly.

No one had ever said something like that to her before.

No one had ever chosen her like that.

She looked down, trying to hide the way her cheeks warmed.

“You don’t even know me.”

“I do,” he said quietly.

She looked up.

“You hide your feelings,” he continued.

“You pretend you’re okay when you’re not.”

“You push people away because you think they won’t stay anyway.”

Luna froze.

“How... do you know all that?”

Kyros smiled faintly.

“Because I see you.”

Those three words hit her harder than anything else.

I see you.

Like she wasn't invisible anymore.

Her eyes softened.

For the first time in a long time...

She didn't feel alone.

“Kyros...” she whispered.

He looked at her, his gaze gentle.

“What if this ends?” she asked.

The question came out before she could stop it.

His expression changed slightly.

Not sadness.

Something deeper.

He reached for her hand again.

This time, his grip was softer.

“If it does,” he said quietly,

“then we'll make every moment before that count.”

Her chest tightened.

“That's not fair,” she said.

He smiled faintly.

“Life isn't fair, Luna.”

A soft breeze passed between them.

She closed her eyes for a second.

Then opened them again.

“I don’t want this to be just a dream,” she admitted.

Kyros leaned closer.

“So don’t treat it like one.”

Her heart skipped again.

For a moment... everything slowed.

The wind.

The light.

Even her thoughts.

All she could feel was him.

“Stay,” he whispered.

Not a command.

Not a demand.

Just a quiet request.

And for the first time in her life...

Luna didn’t think about leaving.